

Pasa Sustainable Agriculture

Conservation Technical Assistance Program

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OUR MISSION:

Cultivating environmentally sound, economically viable, community-focused farms and food systems.

OUR VISION:

A world where agriculture nourishes, heals, and empowers

Pasa SUSTAINABLE AGRICULTURE





Annika Rowland

Conservation TA Program Manager

Practice Implementation and TA



Otis Pierce

Conservation TA Coordinator

Farmer Enrollment and Outreach

Pasa Services and the Farmer Journey

(Some) Pasa Services



Conservation Practices

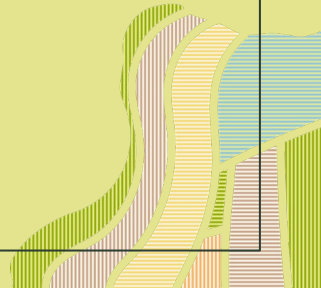
- Technical assistance and implementation funding for:
 - Soil health practices
 - Agroforestry practices
 - Grazing practices
 - Infrastructural improvements

Business Development

- Continuing education scholarships
- Marketing technical assistance
- Market expansion assistance

Research

- Soil Health Testing
- XRF Heavy Metals Testing
- Nutrient density study



Conservation Practice Options

Alley Cropping (311)
Composting Facility (317)
Conservation Cover (327)
Conservation Crop Rotation (328)
Contour Buffer Strips (332)
Cover Crop (340)
Fence (382)
Field Border (386)
Forest Farming (379)
Forest Stand Improvement (666)
Grassed Waterway (412)
Hedgerow Planting (422)
Herbaceous Wind Barriers (603)
High Tunnel System (325)
Irrigation System Micro Irrigation (441)
Livestock Pipeline (516)
Livestock Shelter (576)

Farmstead Energy Improvement/Energy Efficient
Agricultural Operation (374) Access Control (472)
Trails and Walkways (575)
Lighting System Improvement/Energy
Efficient Lighting System (670) Nutrient
Management (590)
Pasture and Hay Planting (512)
Pest Management Conservation System (595)
Prescribed Grazing (528)
Prescribed Burning (338)
Residue and Tillage Management, No-Till (329)
Residue and Tillage Management, Reduced (345)
Riparian Forest Buffer (391)
Soil Carbon Amendment (336/808)
Tree/Shrub Establishment (612)
Windbreak/Shelterbelt Establishment (380)
Watering Facility (614)
Water Harvesting Catchment (636)

Farmer Journey

Apply for
services at
[pasafarming.org](https://pasafarming.org/programs)
/programs

**Centralized intake and
FSA eligibility check**



**Project planning with
Technical Assistance
Provider - technical
assistance may be
provided during any of
the following steps**



Site Visit



**CPA52 Environmental
and Cultural Resource
Review (NRCS)**



**Project
implementation,
participation stipend
and 80% practice
payment**



Practice verification



**Final 20% practice
payment**

What makes Pasa's service provision different?

- Holistic and flexible approach - conservation services coupled with market expansion and business development opportunities
- Farmers as experts
- Generous participation stipend (\$1500 per year)
- No match required
- 80% of total project cost paid up front, 20% upon completion



Case Study

Case Study

Successful PA Farm Project

The Farm:

- Between 2-7 acres
- Organic vegetables
- Incubator farm
- Low budget, big goals



Application Process

The Farmer
applied through
Pasa Services for
Conservation
Practice
Installation

**Pasa Technical
Assistance Provider
(TAP) connected
virtually with the
farmer**



**Priority NRCS
practices were
identified**



**In-person site visit
conducted. Site
evaluated, Practices
mapped**



**TAP wrote CPA-52,
submitted to state
NRCS**

**NRCS provided
feedback, approved
project**



**Pasa paid farmer
participation stipend
and 80% of practice
implementation
dollars up front**



**20% of
implementation
dollars paid upon
completion.**

Approved Practices

Practices

Outcome

484, Mulching	→	Reducing weed pressure
340, Cover Crop	→	Increasing organic matter
595, Pest Management Conservation System	→	Using beneficial insects and insect netting
612, Tree/Shrub Establishment	→	Planting fruit trees
327, Conservation Cover	→	Pollinator habitat
636, Water Harvesting Catchment	→	Water storage for irrigation
374, Energy Efficient Agriculture Operation	→	Improve Insulation in the Greenhouse

Farmer Payments

- Farmer received approximately \$16,000 in upfront payments for all practices.
- Farmer will receive \$4,000 upon practice verification
- Farmer receives yearly participation stipend of \$1,500



Technical Assistance

Development of TA Capacity

Pasa's Goals

- Developing long-term capacity of our team to deliver technical assistance across PA
- Training our team to complete TSP level planning documents and Pasa specific templates
 - Agroforestry Guidance
 - High Tunnel Guidance
- Goal to be nimble and respond to farmer needs



Collaboration with State Programs



Thank you